

COMP1531

26T2

Review and Exam



UNSW
SYDNEY

COMP1531 26T2 Final Exam

Sessions: 1

Day: Monday

Date: 24th August, 2026

Venue: [[check here](#)]

Time: 9:45am to 1:00pm

Duration : 3 hours, 10 minutes reading time

Check your student ID cards and get a new one if it is lost or expired.

Announcements

- A reminder to try exam environment
 - **VERY IMPORTANT**
- Practice Exam questions are available on course website

Help Sessions and Forum



Week 10

Day	Time	Tutor
Monday	6–7pm	Junya
Thursday	6–7pm	Keith

Email: cs1531@cse.unsw.edu.au

Course Goal

- Learn software engineering principles via exposure to the important practice of building correct products in effectively functioning teams.
- Build a strong foundation in the fundamental principles and practices of software engineering.
- You can
 - describe stages of software development lifecycle and implement them
 - reason about good practices of software engineering

What you have learnt

- Software Management – version control (git), teamwork
- Software Process – SDLC
- Software Project – package management, CI/CD, persistence, HTTP, auth, deployment
- Software Verification – static and dynamic verification, coverage
- Software Design – complexity, modelling, maintainability
- Software Requirements – requirement engineering

Assessment

- 10% Labs
- 45% Project
- 45% Final Exam

To pass, you must:

- score **50/100** overall
- Score **18/45** (40%) on the final exam

(For example, 55/100 overall, 17/45 on final exam would result in 55 UF not 55 PS)

Pass Rate

We manually inspect the work of students just below the pass threshold.

- If we see many students who've sufficiently shown competency with basic course material but not passing, the exam mark or other components may be scaled up.

COMP1531 is a challenging course, but pass rate is around the same as the average for level 1 UNSW courses.

Lab Marking

Practical Lab

- 12 assessable (core) practical labs worth 0.75 mark each.

Theory Quiz

- 6 theory quizzes worth 0.5 marks each.

You only need to score 10/12 marks to achieve full marks in the lab component.

The majority of students (>70%) get $\geq 9/10$ marks in labs.

Project Marking

Marking in progress.

- Automarking has already been released to students, via Gitrun

Usually about 77/100 mean.

Final Exam Details

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The Final Exam: When and Where

Invigilated and held in CSE labs - 24th August

Morning session only

- If you have a **clash**, the CSE exams team has already accounted for this [cse.exams@unsw.edu.au]
- You have received an email confirming your final allocation

The Final Exam: When and Where

Your allocation information is available here:

<https://cgi.cse.unsw.edu.au/~exam/26T2/seating/register.cgi/allocations/>

The exact **time and location** of your exam will be made available very soon.

- Please make careful note of this information,
- Arriving at the incorrect time or location may result in you being unable to sit the exam.
- If there is any issue with your allocation please contact <cse.exams@unsw.edu.au> ASAP.

The Final Exam: The rules

UNSW on-campus exam rules apply

- see <https://www.student.unsw.edu.au/exam/rules>

You must:

- **Bring your student card**
- Have your phone, other electronic devices and watches switched off and in your bag
- Have a completely clear water bottle if you choose to bring one
- Not bring your own keyboard/mouse or other hardware
- Deliberate violation of exam conditions will be treated as serious misconduct, and may be referred to the student conduct and integrity unit (SCIU).

The Final Exam: Special Consideration

- This exam is covered by UNSW's **Fit-to-Sit** policy.
- By starting the exam, you are saying “I am well enough to finish the exam.”
- If you are unwell before the exam: see a doctor, apply for Special Consideration, and don't attend.
- If you become unwell during the exam: talk to an exam supervisor ASAP

The Final Exam: The exam environment

- Only materials allowed - You may bring in 1 **handwritten** double-sided A4 page of notes.
- Restricted exam environment. Not your CSE account.
- No access to
 - internet
 - course website
 - your own files



The Final Exam: The Format

- 10 minutes reading time, 3 hours working time
- **Approx** - 50% marks for theory questions and 50% marks for practical questions
- Theory questions: MCQ, short answer questions, open-ended design question
- Practical question: Problem Solving, Implementation
- difficulty is subjective, of course

The Final Exam: The Format

- Each short answer question answered in a separate .md file.
- Each practical question answered in a separate folder.
- MCQs questions answered in the mcq.md.
- Answers will be submitted using a command
 - (e.g., submit --question 23)
- Practical questions will include starter codes.

The Final Exam: The Format

-Autotests will be available for most/all coding questions.

-For example:

```
• type-safety: npm run tsc  
• lint: npm run lint  
• tests: npm run test
```

- Passing autotests does not guarantee any marks - do your own testing.

The Final Exam: Marking

- No marks awarded for **style** or **comments** for practical questions.
- But a human marker may need to be able to deduce the behaviour of your program
- And you should probably be able to read your own code
- Please use reasonable style, variable names, so that we can give you the mark that you deserve
- Comments only necessary to tell the marker something
- Do not include identifying info in comments

The Final Exam: Marking

- Answers will be run through automatic marking software.
 - Please follow the input/output format shown exactly - autotest is a guide to help you achieve this.
 - Please make your program behave as specified.
- Answers that don't pass **all** automarking tests are handmarked, guided by automarking.

The Final Exam: Marking

- Minor errors will only result in a small penalty.
 - Eg. an answer correct except for missing whitespace would receive almost full marks.
- No marks given unless an answer shows substantial progress towards a solution (>33%)
 - No marks just for starting a question and writing some generic code.
 - Zero marks for submitting starter code.

The Final Exam: Special Considerations

- Any ELS extra time has been handled by the CSE exam team - you should see this on the allocations page
- All students see the same exam question text.
- The text shows the standard exam deadline, any extra time is additional to it. If in doubt, talk to the exam supervisor.
- Email us if you have any concerns regarding ELS conditions.



What should you aim to study for

Focus on

- Areas covered in lectures
- Areas covered by the assignments

The majority of questions on the exam will focus on concepts seen here.

What should you aim to study for

Some practical questions have multiple parts in one question.

- They vary in difficulty.
- They are ordered in difficulty level.

See Practise Exam:

<https://cgi.cse.unsw.edu.au/~cs1531/26T2/practice-exam/>

What should you aim to study for

For example:

- Javascript basic, arrays, object and etc.
- Verification, coverage
- HTTP server, API
- SDLC, Software Design
- Managing Swagger Files

Timeline Provisional Results

Lab marks will be returned to you before the exam.

TENTATIVELY - Hopefully we can also return project iteration 2 marks before the exam.

You should have a reasonable estimate of your coursework mark before the exam.

Timeline Provisional Results

TENTATIVELY When marking is complete, exam marks will be made available. We'll make a forum announcement when this occurs.

- You'll have an opportunity have your marking reviewed.
- Reviews are only if there's an issue with the marking, not because you disagree with the mark you received.

Final results will appear on myUNSW on release of results day.

Supplementary Exams

If you miss the original exam due to illness/misadventure, you may be eligible for a supplementary exam; apply for special consideration.

- Students with borderline results are not offered supps. (...except potential graduands.)
- Similar format to final exam.

Wellness for Exams

Important tips: the hours before an exam



Make sure you get a good night's sleep

If you are well rested, you will think more clearly, remember more and be able to solve problems creatively. Don't pull an all-nighter; being alert is your greatest asset.



Pack your bag the night before

Be sure to check what materials you're expected to bring and include extra stationery in case you need it. Neatly organise your materials, especially notes for open-book exams.



Be familiar with your exam location

Make sure you know how to get to the exam with minimum stress well ahead of time. You can visit the exam venue a few days before to establish how you'll get there.



Arrive ahead of time

Plan to get to there at least 30 minutes before the exam start time. This will ensure you aren't stressed and leave some buffer room for unexpected delays.



Avoid panic talk!

You don't want other people's nervousness or stress to rub off on you before an exam. Stand apart from the main scrum of students and keep calm.



Fuel yourself

Easily digestible, solid foods like rice, bread, savoury biscuits or bananas are the best. Keep coffee and sugar to a minimum as these will only give a short boost.

More information can be found here: [Exam preparation | Current Students – UNSW Sydney](#)

What did you like?

Aim of COMP1531 is to give a taste of many topics.



What did you like?

More time to get into interesting things

- More weeks for more tutorial and lab time for requirement engineering
- More time to talk about software design

Labs: a decent bit of work, but hopefully you learned a lot

Project: a lot of work, but hopefully you learned a lot

What did you like?

- Generally comprehensive lab exercises and project
- Our amazing tutors and admins!!
- The hardworking students!!!!

Thanks to

Your lovely teaching staff

- Admins
- Tutors and lab assistants
- Forum staff
- Help session staff
- Assignment authors
- Content improvers
- Assignment markers

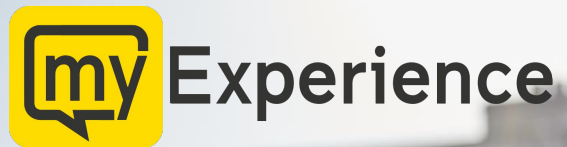
All of you!



myExperience

- How did we do?
- What worked well?
- What worked better?
- Let us know!

Please give your tutors feedback - myExperience is the best way to give them feedback, and it will more likely than not make their day.



COMP1531 Software Eng Fundamentals

Student

<https://go.blueja.io/dLpXyg0leU6Jy8p4omEqDA>

Please be mindful of the [UNSW Student Code of Conduct](#) as you provide feedback. At UNSW we aim to provide a respectful community and ask you to be careful to avoid any language that is sexist, racist or likely to be hurtful. You should feel confident that you can provide both positive and negative feedback, but please be considerate in how you communicate.



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And that's a wrap

- Good luck 🎉
- We hope you've learnt useful things in this course.
- We hope you get the mark you're aiming for!
- You are nearly there!!! Then you can get a nice break!!!

Reach Out

Content Related Questions:

<https://discourse03.cse.unsw.edu.au/26T2/COMP1531>

Admin related questions email:

cs1531@cse.unsw.edu.au



Student Support - I Need Help With...

! Screenshot This Slide

Uni and Life in Australia
Stress, Financial, Visas, Accommodation & More



Student Support

student.unsw.edu.au/advisors

Reporting Sexual Assault/Harassment



Equity Diversity and Inclusion (EDI)

edi.unsw.edu.au/sexual-misconduct

Educational Adjustments
To Manage my Studies and Disability / Health
Condition



Equitable Learning Services (ELS)

student.unsw.edu.au/els

Academic and Study Skills



Academic Skills

student.unsw.edu.au/skills

Special Consideration
Because Life Impacts our Studies and Exams



Special Consideration

student.unsw.edu.au/special-consideration

My Feelings and Mental Health
Managing Low Mood, Unusual Feelings & Depression



Mental Health Connect

student.unsw.edu.au/counselling
Telehealth



Mind HUB

student.unsw.edu.au/mind-hub
Online Self-Help Resources



**In Australia Call Afterhours
UNSW Mental Health Support Line**

1300 787 026
5pm-9am



**Outside Australia Afterhours
24-hour Medibank Hotline**

+61 (2) 8905 0307